PROMOGUARD | WINDOWS DESKTOP + OFFLINE WEB COMPANION

Beginner User Guide

A practical, step-by-step manual for installing, operating, and safely understanding the local PromoGuard research prototype.

Start with this safety boundary
PromoGuard organizes research. It cannot certify a campaign, promise a reward, or make a wallet transaction. Check official sources independently and treat unclear facts as unknown.

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Windows desktop application with an optional local-only web bundle viewer

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1. Executive summary and overview

1.1 What PromoGuard is

PromoGuard is a privacy-focused, local-first Windows desktop research application for collecting and organizing information about possible crypto reward campaigns, airdrops, and similar public offers. The desktop app stores campaign records and review data in a local SQLite database. It can keep dated terms snapshots and evidence, record status history, and help you review possible payment conditions. A separate web companion opens a user-exported data bundle in your browser without uploading it.

Local-first does not mean every optional action is offline. Fetching a public terms page or feed, using a wallet provider, or enabling an RPC lookup contacts an external service after you request or consent to it.

1.2 Core capabilities

- **Organize campaigns:** record a name, source URL, network, token identifier, stated reward, end date, status, and reasons.
- **Preserve evidence:** save a dated terms text snapshot with a SHA-256 hash and compare saved revisions.
- **Review cautiously:** record payment-condition/source attestations, inspect explanations, archive records, and retain status history.
- **Find leads:** optionally read configured public HTTPS RSS/Atom/GDELT feeds; discovered items start unverified.
- **Optional wallet reads:** connect supported wallets and separately consent to public-address lookups. No signing or transaction method is exposed.
- **Optional local AI:** send pasted text to Ollama running on your own computer for advisory summaries and extraction.
- **Export:** write a full JSON backup or a smaller read-only campaign/evidence/history bundle for the offline viewer.

1.3 Explicit limitations and disclaimer

Not an approval, wallet, or financial service
PromoGuard does not trade, sign messages, approve spending, send transactions, submit claims, guarantee eligibility, prove website ownership, certify an offer, or guarantee token payment. **Eligible for review** means only that local checks found no blocking condition in the data available.

- Markets is not a live price/chart service. Live market data is not configured; the view links to public Polymarket pages for separate browsing.
- Predictions is an inactive paper/demo placeholder. It has no active markets, odds, stakes, tokens, prizes, or payouts.
- A URL, feed item, wallet balance increase, AI response, or hash is not independent proof of a campaign or reward.

1.4 Intended audience

The prototype may help crypto researchers, Web3 enthusiasts, and people reviewing public campaign information keep notes and evidence organized. It is not a bug-bounty platform, investment product, legal service, security scanner, or replacement for checking primary sources.

2. System requirements and installation

2.1 Requirements

Item	Requirement / explanation
Operating system	Windows 10/11 desktop; clean-machine setup still needs acceptance testing.
Run from source	Node.js 22.12 or newer and npm.
Project files	Complete project folder containing package.json, package-lock.json, Start PromoGuard.bat, main.js, preload.js, src\\ and renderer\\.
Optional AI	Ollama running locally with the configured model phi3:mini downloaded.
Internet	Not needed for ordinary local records or offline bundle viewing. Needed for optional public terms/feed/provider requests and software/model downloads.

Protect this project folder
Much of the current application source is untracked in Git in this checkout. It runs locally, but a fresh clone may not include all current files. Keep a safe copy and do not assume the online repository contains the complete working project.

2.2 Method A — single-click batch file

1. Install Node.js 22.12 or newer if it is not installed. Check with node --version and npm --version in PowerShell.
2. Open the complete PromoGuard project folder in File Explorer.
3. Double-click Start PromoGuard.bat. If Windows shows a downloaded-file security prompt, verify the file/source first.
4. Wait for the PromoGuard desktop window. Leave it open while you use the app.

If dependencies have not been installed, prepare them first using Method B.

2.3 Method B — PowerShell / terminal

Open PowerShell in the project root (the folder containing package.json), then run:

```
npm ci
npm start
```

- **npm ci** installs exact versions from package-lock.json. Use it for first-time setup, after dependency changes, or to rebuild missing node_modules.
- **npm start** starts the desktop application in Electron. Later, use npm start or the batch file without reinstalling unless dependencies changed.
- If installation fails, confirm you are in the project root and Node meets the minimum version. Do not copy isolated files from another checkout as a repair.

2.4 Close and restart

Close the main PromoGuard window normally to exit. Your local records remain stored; closing the app does not itself erase them. Start it again with the batch file or npm start. Back up data before replacing or moving the project folder.

2.5 Installer build (maintainer/test use)

```
npm run dist -- --config.directories.output=dist-release
```

A successful build does not certify installation. The current installer is unsigned, has no configured author or app icon, and uses Electron's default icon. Install/upgrade/uninstall, data-retention, code-signing, and clean-profile acceptance remain incomplete.

3. Feature guide and practical use

3.1 Overview dashboard

What it is: a local summary of campaign records and recent activity with shortcuts to review, wallet, and Activity screens.

1. Launch PromoGuard; Overview is the opening page.
2. Read the summary tiles and recent-record list. Use Review a campaign, Open campaigns, View all, or quick-access cards to navigate.
3. Open individual records to inspect their evidence and reasons; a count is not evidence of success.

> **Example**
> If the dashboard shows five campaign records and zero records marked received, that means five local research records and no locally recorded received outcomes. It does not mean five opportunities or a wallet balance.

3.2 Campaign review and terms verification

Concept: each campaign record is a research file. A terms snapshot is an immutable dated copy of text for later comparison. The app applies local checks; you remain responsible for checking facts and source ownership.

Create a record

1. Choose PromoGuard in the left navigation or click Review a campaign from Overview.
2. Enter the campaign name and the exact official source URL. Prefer the project terms page, not an advertisement, social post, shortened link, or feed headline.
3. Choose the stated network. Fill token ID, reward amount, and end date only when the official terms provide them; do not guess.
4. Mark no-payment conditions only after confirming the terms do not require a deposit, gas fee, purchase, staking, paid mint, fund transfer, unlimited approval, or seed phrase.
5. Mark the separate official-source checkbox only after independently checking the domain and terms. Add the exact public domain in Settings & AI before it can pass the local allow-list check.
6. Choose Evaluate campaign. Read the resulting status and reasons; new/discovered items start conservatively.

> **Fictional practice example — not an offer**
> **Name:** Example DEX Testnet Campaign
> **Source:** https://example.invalid/terms
> **Network:** eip155:11155111 (Ethereum Sepolia testnet)
> **Reward:** leave blank unless the official terms state a value.
>
> The .invalid domain is reserved for examples, not a real campaign site.

Start a review and save a snapshot

1. Find the record and choose Start review on an unverified campaign.
2. Enter the terms URL. Paste text copied from the site, or choose Fetch official terms to request the public HTTPS page.
3. Review the fetched text and any source/DNS warnings. URL checks, public-IP DNS vetting, DNS-pinned requests, redirect validation, and size/time limits reduce network risk; they do not prove authenticity.

4. Choose Save terms snapshot. The app records the URL, text, capture time, and SHA-256 hash. Keep the snapshot URL identical to the reviewed URL.
5. Read the text. Mark attestations only for facts personally confirmed, then Submit evidence. Leave uncertain conditions unchecked; missing evidence should remain under review.

Compare revisions: save a later snapshot, select two different revisions in the campaign's evidence history, and choose Compare revisions. Added/removed lines show the textual difference—not whether the change is legitimate.

Understand the status

Status	Beginner meaning
Discovered / Unverified	A lead or incomplete record. Gather primary-source evidence; do not treat as approved.
Under review	Evidence, attestations, or facts are missing, uncertain, or inconsistent.
Eligible for review	No local blocking condition was found in the supplied information. Not official approval, qualification, or payment.
Rejected / Ineligible	Local checks or your review found a blocker. Read the explanation; do not bypass it.
Expired	The recorded end date has passed according to local date handling.

Use search, status filter, and Show archived to find records. Edit changes descriptive fields and may require review again. Archive hides a record from the normal list without deleting its research history; toggle archived to unarchive. Reject records your decision to stop reviewing.

Claim preflight is not a claim

The Claim preflight panel contains limited checks or preparation records. Some checks require saved terms and can stop with an explanation. No claim is submitted, no transaction is signed, and a balance increase is not a verified reward receipt.

3.3 Lead discovery with HTTPS feeds

What it is: optional reading of configured public RSS/Atom/GDELT feeds to find possible announcements. It is a lead finder, not a campaign verifier.

1. Open PromoGuard and locate Discover campaign leads.
2. Enter a public HTTPS feed URL and choose Add feed. Unsafe schemes, IP literals, and private destinations are rejected.
3. Check the feed list; remove sources you no longer want. Removing a feed resets scheduled-check consent.
4. Choose Run discovery now. Read the dialog listing the sites to contact; choose Allow once only if you intend to make that request.
5. Inspect counts/errors and investigate each lead at its official source. Feed discoveries always begin unverified.
6. For scheduled checks, choose 15–1,440 minutes and Allow schedule. Read the separate consent dialog. Feed or interval changes require renewed consent; Stop schedule disables it.

> **Privacy reminder**
> A feed run contacts the listed feed hosts. The consent dialog states that only the feed request is sent; no wallet address or personal data is shared. Feed content is untrusted.

4. Wallet Center — optional read-only paths

Wallet functions have external-provider dependencies. If you are new to wallets, skip this section until you understand public addresses, networks, and provider privacy. Begin on a testnet. Mainnet contains real assets even though PromoGuard's supported path is read-only.

> **Critical wallet rule**
> **Never type or send a seed phrase (mnemonic), private key, or wallet password to PromoGuard or anyone claiming to support it.** PromoGuard exposes no signing, approval, transfer, or claim-submission API. Cancel any unexpected wallet request.

4.1 TON Connect

1. You need a public HTTPS host under your control for a TON Connect manifest JSON. docs\\tonconnect-manifest.template.json is only a template; it is not hosted for you.
2. In Wallet Center, paste the HTTPS .json URL and choose Save manifest URL.
3. Select TON Testnet, choose Load wallets, select a wallet, then choose Connect TON wallet. Read the confirmation about sites contacted and approve in the wallet only if expected.
4. Connection is separate from data lookup. Choose Allow balance and history lookups only after reading that TON Center will receive your public address and network.
5. Choose Refresh and review provider/time. Balance/token/incoming-transfer data is public data; a change is not automatically a campaign reward.
6. Revoke lookup consent to stop future reads; Disconnect to end the connection; Erase local TON data to clear local session/cache and revoke consent. The saved manifest URL remains.

4.2 WalletConnect / Trust Wallet (EVM)

1. Create your own WalletConnect/Reown project ID through its official service. PromoGuard does not provide one; do not borrow another user's ID.
2. Enter the ID and choose Save project ID. The app uses OS encryption when available; the UI may say a value is session-only if it cannot be stored persistently.
3. Choose a testnet such as BNB Smart Chain Testnet or Ethereum Sepolia. Avoid mainnet when learning.
4. If you need reads, check an HTTPS RPC provider's privacy/terms, enter its URL, and choose Use this RPC for selected network.
5. Choose Connect Trust Wallet (QR), scan with the wallet, and verify the requested connection/network. Cancel any unexpected signing/approval/transaction request.
6. Choose Allow balance lookups only if willing to send the public address to the selected RPC provider. Refresh reads the native balance. EVM token discovery and transaction history are not available.
7. Use Revoke lookup consent, Disconnect, or Erase local data as needed. Clear local wallet metadata clears local metadata/lookup permissions; it cannot erase blockchain records. Saved RPC URL handling is separate.

A public address may be linked to your use when sent to an RPC/provider. Read its terms. Windows safe-storage capability affects whether sessions can be encrypted persistently; some values may be memory-only if OS storage is unavailable.

5. Activity, Analytics, Settings, and AI

5.1 Activity and Analytics

Open Activity for local counters, notifications, alerts, and claim-preflight records. It is not a live service-health monitor; inspect feed and wallet panels for their own errors. Dismiss a notification with Dismiss. A locally recorded “received” state is not independent proof.

Analytics charts summarize local campaign status/network, payment flags, status changes per day, and bins of stated token amounts. These are not market data, token prices, earnings, or forecasts.

5.2 Domain allow-list and reward threshold

1. Open Settings & AI. Under Campaign domain allow-list, add only an exact public domain you independently verified. Removing a domain may require campaigns to be reviewed again.
2. The allow-list is a local policy gate, not proof of domain ownership or legitimacy.
3. Under Minimum stated reward, enter a non-negative threshold in token units and choose Save threshold. This does not convert the amount to a currency value; zero still requires a positive reward.

5.3 Local AI via Ollama

PromoGuard calls Ollama at http://localhost:11434 and the configured model is phi3:mini. Install Ollama from its official source. Download the model once and ensure its local service is running:

```
ollama pull phi3:mini
```

If Ollama is not already running in the background, start it with **ollama serve** in a separate terminal and leave that terminal open. If the Ollama app/service is already running, skip this command to avoid starting a second server.

In Settings & AI, paste terms/text into Campaign terms or text to analyze. Choose Summarize rules, Extract amounts & deadlines, Compare with policy, Explain risk indicators, or Write evidence summary. Compare every output with the original terms. Input is capped and sanitized, but an AI can still miss conditions or be manipulated by source text.

> **AI privacy and accuracy**
> With the default setting, text is sent to Ollama on this computer, not a PromoGuard-hosted AI account. Do not redirect the endpoint to another host unless you understand what that host receives. AI cannot decide eligibility or replace human source checking.

5.4 MCP tools (advanced and optional)

When configured, the MCP list shows tool names and granted/revoked state. Inspect each tool before granting. Choose Grant only for the specific tool you understand; enter its exact listed name and valid JSON arguments, then choose Invoke granted tool. Revoke when finished. An empty list means no tools are available. Invoking a tool cannot grant its own permission.

6. Markets and Predictions

Markets: live data is not configured and no prices/charts are fabricated. The view links to the public Polymarket site and API documentation for separate browsing. PromoGuard itself provides no trading, buying, selling, brokerage, or financial recommendations.

Predictions (Paper): an inactive educational placeholder, not a functional simulator or live market. It has no forecasts, live odds, stakes, deposits, redeemable points, prizes, or payouts.

> **A visible tab does not mean a live service**
> Treat the current UI/status as the authority on what is active. Inactive sections do not generate or verify data.

7. Data export and backup management

7.1 Full desktop backup

1. On the PromoGuard campaign page, choose Export backup.
2. Choose a destination in the save dialog and save the JSON file; cancel means no export.
3. Store it privately. It is unencrypted and may contain campaigns, terms evidence/history, app settings, and provider URLs/settings that may contain tokens.
4. To restore, choose Import backup and select a PromoGuard backup. The app validates before writing and imports transactionally; duplicate matching records may be skipped.
5. Scheduled discovery consent is reset after import. Inspect your records and settings, then review schedule status before enabling it again. Keep the source backup until you confirm restoration.

7.2 Read-only web bundle

1. Choose Export read-only web bundle on the campaign page and save the JSON package.
2. Open web\\index.html in a modern browser. This is separate from renderer\\index.html; the renderer HTML is not the full Electron application.
3. Choose the file picker and select the exported bundle. The page validates its version/relationships and displays campaigns, evidence, and status history.
4. Use Search campaigns to match name, publisher, network, status, or reason. Use Show records for to filter evidence/history to one campaign.
5. Choose Clear local view when finished. This page does not edit the desktop database, log in, upload, or sync.

The web bundle excludes wallet records, provider credentials, and settings, but includes terms evidence text. Treat it as private. It is not encrypted, hosted, or an API. Its restrictive Content Security Policy blocks outbound connections, and imported values are rendered as text.

8. Golden rules of Web3 research

Stop if a supposedly free offer asks for payment or secrets
Do not send funds, sign an unexpected request, or reveal a recovery phrase to “verify” a reward.

[ ] **Red flags:** reject requests for gas paid to a person/site, deposits, purchases, staking, transfers, paid mints, or unlimited token approvals to receive a supposedly free reward.

[ ] **Never disclose secrets:** no review requires a seed phrase, private key, wallet password, or recovery code.

[ ] **Verify domains independently:** follow a reliable official project source, check spelling, and avoid search advertisements and shortened links. An allow-list entry is not proof.

[ ] **Read original terms:** check dates, region, fees, eligibility, and required transactions. Do not rely on an AI summary or feed headline.

[ ] **Protect exports:** full backups are plaintext and can include sensitive settings. Keep them encrypted/private.

[ ] **Understand provider consent:** wallet lookups may send the public address/network to a named provider. Revoke future lookup consent when no longer needed.

[ ] **Keep unknown as unknown:** missing evidence is not proof that a requirement is absent. Eligible for review is not a promise or instruction to claim.

If you see…	Safer action
“Send a fee to unlock a free reward”	Stop, do not pay, and verify via the project’s independently located official source.
“Enter your seed phrase”	Close the page. Never enter it; the phrase controls the wallet.
Unexpected signing/approval request	Cancel. PromoGuard’s research/read-only purpose does not require transaction signing.
A link in a feed or AI answer	Treat it as an unverified lead and find the project’s official source independently.
Missing or contradictory terms	Leave attestations unchecked and keep the record unverified/under review.

9. Architecture, tests, and current project status

9.1 How the project works

Component	Plain-language role
Electron main process (main.js)	Owns the local database, file dialogs, validated privileged operations, network services, and IPC handlers.
Preload bridge (preload.js)	Exposes a limited set of named actions. Renderer code does not get unrestricted Node.js or database access.
Renderer (renderer\\)	Displays desktop pages and requests allowed operations through the preload bridge.
SQLite (src\\)	Stores campaign records, review/evidence history, settings, and related local data.
Safe network modules	For supported fetches: HTTPS policy, public-IP vetting, vetted-IP pinning, redirect checks, and response/time limits.
Offline web companion (web\\)	Validates and displays only a user-selected read-only JSON bundle; no network API or sync.

9.2 Verification snapshot

Check	Latest verified status
Automated tests	161 passed, 0 failed on 03 November 2026. Provider/wallet tests are mocked.
Desktop smoke	390px and 1180px; both exited 0 with failed: [].
JavaScript syntax	62 project JavaScript files passed.
Offline web	Synthetic bundle import, search, and campaign-scoped evidence/history filtering exercised in browser preview.
Windows package	NSIS build succeeded. It is unsigned; no clean-profile installation/upgrade/uninstall test was performed.
Still not established	Live provider acceptance, clean install, accessibility acceptance, independent penetration/legal review, or production readiness.

Does it work?
The tested local desktop prototype and offline bundle viewer worked in the recorded checks. This is not a fully validated public release. External providers have not completed live acceptance, the installer is unsigned, clean-computer/data-lifecycle testing remains, and live market/prediction/claim features are unavailable or deliberately disabled.

9.3 Common questions

Q. Does Eligible for review mean I will get tokens?
No. It means local rules did not find a blocker in supplied data. The project controls qualification and payment.

Q. Does a saved hash prove a source is official?
No. It checks consistency of saved text; it does not identify who published it.

Q. Can I use PromoGuard without a wallet?
Yes. Campaign research, evidence, backup, and the offline bundle need no wallet connection.

Q. Does the web viewer sync with desktop?
No. It reads a file. Export/import a new bundle to view later desktop changes.

Q. Why is Wallet Center empty?
Check provider setup, network, wallet connection, RPC/manifest, and separate lookup-consent status.

Q. Can AI decide if a campaign is safe?
No. It may hallucinate. Compare every statement with official terms and independent sources.

Q. Is this a production release?
No. It is a local prototype; tests/build do not establish clean installation, provider support, signing, or production readiness.

For current technical verification, see TEST_REPORT.md; for the staged roadmap, see FUTURE_UPGRADE_PLAN.md. When this guide and the current app differ, use the app's current status messaging and ask the project maintainer.